Textile Wholesale Catalog Link – Requirement & Feature Document

Oct 28, 2026 · @Prince

1. Overview

We are building a SaaS platform (working name: **CatalogLink**) that gives every Surat textile wholesaler one live catalog link, fed from their own Google Sheet and Google Drive, where their customers browse, add to cart and place orders.

Problem today

- Wholesalers and resellers in Surat share every new design and stock update on WhatsApp, one photo and one message at a time.
- The same photos, price, fabric and set details go to every customer again and again.
- Customers reply with screenshots; the wholesaler rebuilds the order by hand and often sells stock that is already gone.

Solution

- Super Admin adds a client (wholesaler); the system auto-generates a unique catalog link for that client.
- The client connects a Google Sheet. Every product row in the sheet (with image links from Google Drive) shows up on the link automatically.
- The client can also create extra links manually for specific customers or customer groups.
- Customers open the link on their phone (no app, no login needed to browse), add products to cart and place the order.
- The client receives the order on their dashboard and on WhatsApp, and manages quantity (stock) in the same Google Sheet.

Reference: Showkase solves a similar problem for corporate gifting. Our product is the same idea adapted for textile wholesale (sets, colours, MOQ, catalog-wise selling) with Google Sheet as the main data source.

2. Goals and success metrics

The product succeeds when a wholesaler stops forwarding photos on WhatsApp and sends one link instead.

Goal	How we measure it
Client goes live fast	Sheet connected and first link shared within 15 minutes of signup
No repeated photo sharing	New products appear on the link only by adding a row in the sheet
Orders come in structured	Orders placed on the link, not typed in WhatsApp chat
Correct stock	Out-of-stock products are hidden or marked automatically from the sheet qty
Easy for customers	Customer can place an order without installing an app

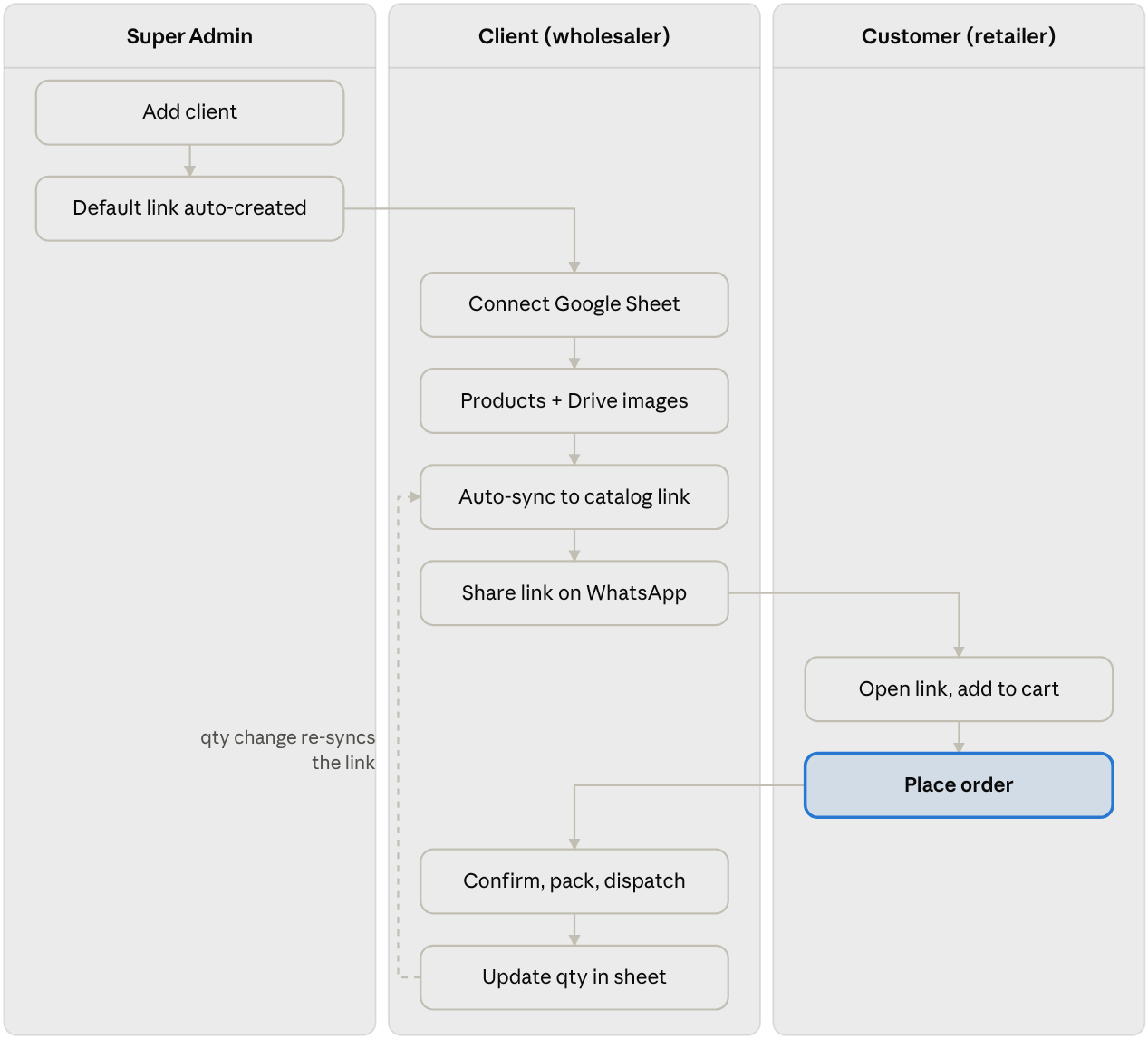
3. User roles

The platform has three roles, plus optional staff logins under a client.

Role	Who	Main work	Access
Super Admin	Our company (platform owner)	Add/manage clients, plans, subscription, support	Full platform
Client	Textile wholesaler / reseller in Surat	Connect sheet, manage products, links, customers, orders	Own business data only
Client Staff (optional)	Client's sales / order team	Handle orders and customers	Role-based, set by client
Customer	Retailer, reseller or shop owner buying from the client	Browse catalog link, add to cart, place order, track order	Only the links shared with them

4. End-to-end user flow

One sheet row becomes a product the customer can order



end-to-end flow · 3 roles, 10 steps

Super Admin sets up the client once; after that the client only edits the sheet, and every qty change flows back to the customer link on the next sync.

5. Super Admin panel features

Super Admin controls who uses the platform; adding a client auto-creates that client's default catalog link.

5.1 Client management

- Add client: business name, owner name, mobile (WhatsApp), email, GST number (optional), city, address, logo.
- On save, the system auto-generates a unique default catalog link, e.g. `cataloglink.in/c/shree-krishna-textiles`.
- Edit, activate, deactivate or delete a client. A deactivated client's links show a "catalog not available" page.
- Send login credentials to the client on WhatsApp / email.
- Login as client (impersonate) for support.

5.2 Plans and subscription

- Create plans with limits: number of products, number of custom links, staff logins, orders per month.
- Assign plan, set start/expiry date, free trial days.
- Payment record (manual entry or payment gateway such as Razorpay in Phase 2).
- Auto-reminder before plan expiry.

5.3 Monitoring and reports

- Dashboard: total clients, active clients, links created, orders placed today / this month.
- Client-wise usage: products synced, last sheet sync time, sync errors.
- Sync error log so support can see why a client's sheet failed.

5.4 Platform settings

- Default sheet template (downloadable) for new clients.
- WhatsApp / SMS / email notification templates.
- Domain and branding settings.

6. Client panel features

The client (wholesaler) runs the whole business from a mobile-friendly web dashboard; product data stays in their Google Sheet.

6.1 Onboarding

- Login with mobile OTP or email + password.
- Business profile: logo, banner, business name, WhatsApp number, address, GST, payment details (UPI / bank) shown to customers.

- Step-by-step setup: download sheet template → connect Google account → select sheet → sync → share link.

6.2 Google Sheet connection

- Connect Google account (OAuth) and pick a sheet, or paste a sheet link shared with our service account.
- Map columns if the client's sheet uses different headers.
- Sync now button + auto-sync every few minutes.
- Sync status: last synced time, rows added / updated, rows with errors (missing price, broken image link).

6.3 Product view (read from sheet)

- Product list with search and filter by category, catalog, stock status.
- Preview how each product looks on the customer link.
- Hide / show a product on the link without deleting the sheet row (Active column).

6.4 Catalog link management

- Default link auto-created by Super Admin (shows all active products).
- **Create manual links** for a specific customer or group: choose products by category, catalog name or individual selection.
- Per-link settings: link name, expiry date, show/hide price, customer-specific price (Phase 2), password / OTP protection, allow ordering on/off.
- Copy link, share on WhatsApp in one tap, generate QR code.
- Link analytics: opens, unique visitors, products viewed, add-to-carts, orders.

6.5 Customer management

- Customer list auto-created from orders (name, shop name, mobile, city, GST).
- Add customers manually and assign links to them.
- Customer-wise order history.
- Block a customer from ordering.

6.6 Order management

- See section 9.

6.7 Staff logins (Phase 2)

- Add staff with roles: order handler, viewer, admin.

7. Google Sheet + Drive integration

One row in the sheet = one product on the link; images live in the client's Google Drive, so there is no image upload or storage on our side.

How it works

1. Client downloads our sheet template (or uses their own sheet and maps columns).
2. Client uploads product photos to a Google Drive folder and sets sharing to "Anyone with the link can view".
3. Client pastes the image link(s) into the sheet row, or pastes one Drive folder link per product and the system picks all images in it.
4. System syncs the sheet (auto every few minutes + "Sync now" button) and updates the catalog link.
5. When an order is confirmed, the system can reduce qty in the sheet automatically (setting on/off, see section 10).

Suggested sheet columns

Column	Required	Example	Notes
Product Code / SKU	Yes	SK-1021	Unique; used to match orders and stock
Product Name	Yes	Banarasi Silk Saree	
Catalog Name	No	Rangoli Vol-3	Groups designs into a catalog
Category	Yes	Saree / Kurti / Dress Material / Lehenga	Used for filters
Fabric	No	Pure Georgette	
Colours / Variants	No	Red, Green, Blue	Comma separated
Sizes	No	M, L, XL, XXL	For kurti / readymade
Pieces per Set	No	4	Set-wise selling
Wholesale Price (₹)	Yes	850	Per piece or per set

Column	Required	Example	Notes
MRP (₹)	No	1499	
Price Type	No	Per piece / Per set	
MOQ	No	1 set	Minimum order qty
Available Qty	Yes	120	Managed by client
Image Links	Yes	Drive link(s)	Multiple links comma separated
Video Link	No	Drive / YouTube link	
Description	No	Free text	
GST %	No	5	
Active (Yes/No)	Yes	Yes	No = hidden from link
Tags	No	New Arrival, Wedding	Shows badges

Technical notes

- Google Sheets API + Google Drive API; OAuth for client accounts.
- Convert Drive share links into direct image URLs and cache thumbnails (CDN) for fast loading on mobile.
- Validation on sync: skip rows missing SKU, price or image, and show the error row number to the client.
- Respect Google API limits; queue syncs per client.

8. Customer catalog link

The link opens like a mini online store in any mobile browser, branded with the client's logo, with no app download.

- **Branded header:** client logo, business name, banner, WhatsApp / call button.
- **Product listing:** grid view with image, name, price, set info, "New" / "Out of stock" badges.
- **Search and filters:** by category, catalog name, fabric, price range, colour, new arrivals.
- **Catalog view:** open a full catalog (e.g. "Rangoli Vol-3") and see all its designs together.

- **Product detail:** image gallery with zoom, video, fabric, sizes, colours, set pieces, MOQ, price, available qty.
- **Select variant:** colour / size / full set; quantity with MOQ check and max = available stock.
- **Share product:** customer can forward a single product to WhatsApp.
- **Wishlist / shortlist** (Phase 2).
- **Language:** English + Hindi / Gujarati labels (Phase 2).
- **Privacy options per link:** price visible only after OTP login; password-protected link.
- **Fast on low network:** compressed thumbnails, lazy loading.

9. Cart, order and order management

Customers place a structured order on the link; the client confirms it on the dashboard and the customer tracks it on the same link.

9.1 Customer side

- Add to cart with variant and qty; cart shows item total, GST (if set) and grand total.
- Checkout: name, shop name, mobile (OTP verify), city, delivery address, GST number (optional), transport / courier preference, notes.
- Payment mode as set by client: Pay later / credit, UPI QR, bank transfer details, online payment (Phase 2).
- Order confirmation page + order details sent on WhatsApp.
- "My orders" on the link (via mobile OTP) to see status.
- Re-order a previous order in one tap (Phase 2).

9.2 Client side

- New order alert on dashboard + WhatsApp / email.
- Order list with filters: new, confirmed, packed, dispatched, delivered, cancelled.
- Order detail: customer info, items, variants, qty, total, notes.
- Actions: accept, edit qty (partial accept when stock is short), reject with reason, mark payment received.
- Status update: confirmed → packed → dispatched (transport name, LR / AWB number) → delivered.
- Download order as PDF / print packing slip; export orders to Excel.
- Option to write every order into an **Orders** tab of the same Google Sheet.

9.3 Order statuses

Status	Who sets it	Customer sees
Placed	System	Order received
Confirmed	Client	Order confirmed
Partially confirmed	Client	Some items not available
Packed	Client	Being packed
Dispatched	Client	Shipped + transport / LR details
Delivered	Client	Delivered
Cancelled / Rejected	Client or customer	Cancelled with reason

10. Stock / quantity management

The Google Sheet's **Available Qty** column is the single source of truth for stock; the client edits it manually and the link follows.

- Qty 0 → product shows "Out of stock" (or is hidden, as per client setting).
- Low stock badge ("Only 5 left") below a threshold the client sets.
- Customer cannot add more than the available qty to cart.
- Stock check again at checkout, so two customers cannot buy the same last set.
- **Auto-deduct setting (on/off):** when the client confirms an order, the system reduces qty in the sheet; a cancelled order adds it back.
- If auto-deduct is off, the client updates qty in the sheet manually and the link shows it after the next sync.
- Variant-wise stock (per colour / size) in Phase 2 via extra columns.

11. Notifications

WhatsApp is the main channel, because both clients and customers already live there.

Event	To client	To customer	Channel
New order placed	Yes	Order received	WhatsApp, email, dashboard
Order confirmed / partially confirmed	–	Yes	WhatsApp
Order dispatched (with LR / AWB)	–	Yes	WhatsApp
Order cancelled / rejected	Yes	Yes	WhatsApp
New products added to a link	–	Optional broadcast	WhatsApp (Phase 2)
Sheet sync failed	Yes	–	Dashboard, email
Plan expiring	Yes	–	WhatsApp, email

MVP can use click-to-WhatsApp (wa.me) messages; Phase 2 moves to the WhatsApp Business API for automatic messages.

12. Reference: Showkase vs our product

Showkase is built for corporate gifting (quotes, logo mockups, gift boxes); we keep its core idea of one private link and adapt the rest for textile wholesale.

Area	Showkase (gifting)	Our product (textile wholesale)
Product source	Catalog in app, photos from Drive folder, Excel import	Live Google Sheet + Drive image links, auto-sync
Link	One private link per client	Default link per client + manual links per customer / group
Customer action	Shortlist, approve quote, approve logo mockup	Add to cart and place order directly
Selling unit	Pieces with MOQ	Piece, set, catalog; colours and sizes

Area	Showkase (gifting)	Our product (textile wholesale)
Stock	Optional, counts itself	Managed in sheet, optional auto-deduct
After order	Quotes, dispatch, challan, samples	Order status, transport / LR details, Orders tab in sheet
Pricing (reference)	Pro ₹20,000/yr, Premium ₹30,000/yr	To be decided

Ideas worth taking from Showkase for Phase 2: link-open tracking, client-wise pricing, search by photo, dispatch tracking on the customer link.

13. Phase plan

MVP covers the full loop: sheet → link → cart → order → stock; everything else waits for Phase 2 and 3.

Module	MVP (Phase 1)	Phase 2	Phase 3
Super Admin	Add client, auto link, plans (manual), activate / deactivate	Razorpay subscription, usage reports	Reseller / partner panel
Google Sheet sync	Template, connect, auto + manual sync, error log	Column mapping, variant-wise stock	Two-way edit from dashboard
Catalog links	Default link, manual links, WhatsApp share, QR	Customer-wise price, password / OTP link, expiry, analytics	Multiple branches / brands
Customer link	Listing, filters, detail, gallery, cart, checkout	Wishlist, Hindi / Gujarati, re-order	Search by photo (AI)
Orders	Order list, statuses, PDF, Excel export, Orders tab in sheet	Partial confirm, LR / AWB tracking, online payment	Invoice + GST billing
Stock	Qty from sheet, out-of-stock, cart limit	Auto-deduct on confirm, low-stock alert	Multi-warehouse

Module	MVP (Phase 1)	Phase 2	Phase 3
Notifications	Click-to-WhatsApp, email	WhatsApp Business API, new-arrival broadcast	Automated follow-ups
Staff	Single client login	Staff roles	Activity log

14. Non-functional requirements

- **Mobile first:** customer link and client dashboard fully usable on a phone; link loads in under 3 seconds on 4G.
- **Data isolation:** each client's products, customers and orders are private (multi-tenant).
- **Security:** HTTPS, OTP login, Google OAuth tokens encrypted, role-based access.
- **Scale:** support 500+ clients and 10,000+ products per client without slowdown.
- **Sync reliability:** retry failed syncs, never delete products on the link because of a temporary Google API error.
- **Image performance:** thumbnail cache / CDN for Drive images.
- **Backups:** daily database backup.
- **Suggested tech stack:** Laravel or Node.js backend, React / Next.js front end, MySQL / PostgreSQL, Redis queue for sync, Google Sheets + Drive API.